

CURRENT AFFAIRS

PREHENSIVE DIGEST

June 2026 | India & World

National Affairs	International Relations	Economy & Finance
Science & Technology	Environment & Climate	Sports & Awards
Defence & Security	Governance & Polity	MCQ Practice Set

Prepared for: UPSC | SSC | Banking | State PSC | All Competitive Exams

This digest covers major events from May–June 2026 across national and international domains.

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CHAPTER 1

National Affairs — India

1.1 Political & Governance Updates

India's political landscape in mid-2026 continues to be shaped by the aftermath of Operation Sindoor, ongoing state assembly elections, and India's active engagement in multilateral summits. The BJP-led NDA government at the Centre remains focused on infrastructure development, digital governance, and national security amid heightened tensions with Pakistan.

Key Highlights:

- **State Elections 2026:** Bihar, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, and Goa are among the states scheduled for assembly elections in 2026. The outcomes will have significant implications for the 2029 general election arithmetic.
- **Presidential Address:** The Union Budget session saw robust debate on India's fiscal consolidation roadmap and capital expenditure plans.
- **India-Nordic Summit (Oslo, 2026):** India upgraded ties with Nordic nations into a 'Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership', focusing on renewable energy, green hydrogen, and Arctic cooperation.
- **BRICS Summit 2026:** India hosts the BRICS Summit, with Chinese President Xi Jinping's possible visit adding a significant geopolitical dimension to bilateral relations.

Summit	India-Nordic Green Technology & Innovation Strategic Partnership
Location	Oslo, Norway (Third India-Nordic Summit)
Previous	1st – Stockholm 2018; 2nd – Copenhagen 2022
Focus Areas	Renewable energy, green hydrogen, Arctic research, STEM innovation
Trade	Enhanced cooperation in supply chains and value-chain integration

1.2 Economic & Infrastructure Milestones

India maintained its position as the world's fastest-growing major economy despite headwinds from US tariffs. GDP growth of 8.2% was recorded in the July-September quarter. However, the full impact of Trump's tariff regime on Indian exports and the broader economy is being closely monitored.

- **US Tariffs on India:** The Trump administration imposed 50% tariffs on India over its purchase of Russian crude oil and failure to conclude a bilateral trade deal, straining India-US economic ties.
- **South Coast Railway Zone:** Indian Railways launched a new 18-star logo following the creation of the South Coast Railway Zone — a significant reorganisation of rail infrastructure in southern India.
- **IndiaAI Data Lab:** Chandigarh University became the first private university to launch an IndiaAI Data Lab in partnership with Intel, advancing AI-focused education and research.

- **Samadhan Didi:** India launched an AI chatbot for citizen grievance redressal — an initiative to integrate AI into public service delivery at the grassroots level.
- **Navachar Mantra:** The Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (MSDE) launched 'Navachar Mantra' to empower rural innovators and entrepreneurs through structured skill development.

1.3 Social & Humanitarian

The Kasauli forest fire in Himachal Pradesh brought attention to India's aerial firefighting capabilities. The Indian Air Force deployed 'Bambi Buckets' — specially designed water-carrying buckets attached to helicopters — to combat the fire. This underscored the growing role of the IAF in disaster management.

A fire at a private hospital in Muzaffarpur, Bihar killed at least four people and injured more than 13 others, raising concerns about fire safety standards in private healthcare facilities across India.

CHAPTER 2

Operation Sindoor & India-Pakistan Relations

2.1 Background: Pahalgam Terror Attack

On April 22, 2025, a devastating terrorist attack struck Pahalgam in the Baisaran Valley of Indian-administered Kashmir. The attack targeted tourists, killing 26 people. India attributed the attack to Pakistan-based terrorist groups Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) and Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM). This event triggered the most significant military confrontation between India and Pakistan in decades.

2.2 Operation Sindoor — Key Details

Launch Date	May 7, 2025 (1:05 AM – 1:30 AM IST)
Operation Name	Operation Sindoor (named after the red sindoor worn by married women)
Targets	9 terrorist infrastructure sites in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK)
Groups Targeted	Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) headquarters
India's Stance	Focused, measured, non-escalatory; no Pakistani military facilities targeted
Lead Officers	Wing Commander Vyomika Singh, Colonel Sofiya Qureshi
Weaponry	Israeli-origin Harop and Harpy loitering munitions; precision missiles
Air Defence	8 PAF air-defence sites struck on May 8; 4 more on May 9
PAF Losses	5 PAF jets (F-16 and JF-17) shot down (IAF claim)
Ceasefire	May 10, 2025 — mediated with US involvement (disputed by India)

2.3 Key Outcomes & Impact

- **Air Superiority:** A Swiss CHPM think-tank report concluded that India's air superiority 'coerced' Pakistan into requesting a ceasefire. India demonstrated deep-strike capability without crossing nuclear thresholds.
- **Naval Deployment:** Over 30 Indian naval ships and submarines were mobilised. The Indian Navy's carrier battle group under INS Vikrant was positioned off the Makran coast, forcing Pakistan's navy to stay close to its own coast.
- **Diplomatic Fallout:** India-US relations cooled as India refused to credit President Trump for brokering the ceasefire. Trump imposed additional tariffs on India citing Russian crude oil purchases.
- **Pakistan's Rebound:** Despite military setbacks, Pakistan gained international visibility by hosting US-Iran talks (April 2026) and being seen as a peacemaker in West Asia.

- **India's New Doctrine:** Indian leaders declared that future terror attacks will be met with 'firm, decisive and unwavering' military response.

2.4 India-Pakistan Relations in 2026

A year after Operation Sindoor, the ceasefire holds but tensions persist. India has been actively working to isolate Pakistan diplomatically, while Pakistan has leveraged its role in de-escalating the US-Iran conflict to rehabilitate its international image. The Line of Control (LoC) remains tense with sporadic violations. Trade and people-to-people contact between the two nations remain suspended.

CHAPTER 3

International Relations

3.1 USA

- **Iran Military Operations (Operation Epic Fury):** The US conducted military operations against Iran. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio confirmed to the House Foreign Affairs Committee that the initial phase of operations has concluded. The US House of Representatives voted 215-208 to limit war powers and halt further military operations against Iran.
- **Drug Boat Strikes:** US military strikes on alleged drug boats since September 2025 have killed over 200 people, drawing legal and ethical scrutiny.
- **Albania Development Controversy:** A luxury coastal development project in Albania linked to Jared Kushner and Ivanka Trump faced protests from Albanian citizens and environmentalists over transparency and ecological concerns.
- **US 250th Anniversary:** On July 4, 2026, the United States will celebrate its Semiquincentennial — the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence.

3.2 Russia-Ukraine War

The Russia-Ukraine conflict continued into 2026. On June 2, 2026, Russia launched a massive aerial attack on Kyiv and other Ukrainian cities, killing at least 22 civilians and wounding 138. In retaliation, Ukrainian drones struck an oil terminal in St. Petersburg and military facilities at the Kronstadt naval base, targeting Russian assets during the St. Petersburg International Economic Forum.

3.3 West Asia (Middle East)

- **Iran-Israel Tensions:** Israeli strikes killed at least nine people including two paramedics in southern Lebanon, violating the ongoing ceasefire agreement.
- **Kuwait-Iran Dispute:** Kuwait expelled two Iranian diplomats, declaring them persona non grata, and summoned Iran's acting chargé d'affaires over attacks attributed to Iranian proxies.
- **Pakistan's Peacemaker Role:** Pakistan hosted direct US-Iran talks in Islamabad (April 11-12, 2026), gaining significant international recognition.

3.4 Africa & Other Regions

- **DRC Violence:** Allied Democratic Forces (ADF) fighters killed 16 civilians in a village in Beni Territory, North Kivu Province, Democratic Republic of Congo.
- **Ebola Outbreak (DRC):** An Ebola outbreak in Mongbwalu, DRC required emergency deployment of health workers and isolation infrastructure, drawing WHO attention.
- **Ecuador Crime:** Ecuadorian police discovered the bodies of 8 missing individuals in plastic bags near Babahoyo, Los Rios Province, highlighting persistent organised crime issues.
- **Somalia:** Heavy fighting erupted in Mogadishu after opposition Somali Future Council forces were attacked by forces loyal to the disputed president.

3.5 OPEC & Energy

Event	UAE withdraws from OPEC (May 1, 2026)
OPEC Role	Coordinates petroleum policies of member nations
UAE Reason	Strategic diversification; UAE had long been at odds with OPEC quotas
Impact	Potential shift in global oil pricing dynamics; OPEC's relevance questioned

3.6 Israel — Ultra-Orthodox Protests

Tens of thousands of ultra-Orthodox Jews demonstrated across Israel in June 2026, blocking roads, disrupting trains, and setting cars ablaze in protest against mandatory military enlistment. The Israeli Supreme Court had earlier ruled that ultra-Orthodox men cannot be exempted from military service, creating a major domestic political crisis for the Netanyahu government.

CHAPTER 4

Economy & Finance

4.1 India's Economic Outlook

India remained the world's fastest-growing major economy in 2025-26, driven by robust domestic consumption, infrastructure investment, and a booming digital economy. However, global headwinds — particularly US tariffs and trade restrictions — began to impact export sectors from early 2026.

GDP Growth (Jul-Sep 2025)	8.2% — fastest among major economies
GDP Growth Outlook 2026	Projected to moderate due to US tariff impacts
US Tariff on India	50% on goods linked to Russian crude oil purchases
Inflation	Within RBI's 2–6% comfort band; food inflation closely monitored
Forex Reserves	Among the highest globally; RBI maintains stability
Digital Economy	India's digital payments ecosystem continues global leadership

4.2 Global Economic Trends

- **World Economic Forum 2026 (Davos):** Key themes included AI's impact on labour markets, green transition financing, and geopolitical risk management in global supply chains.
- **US Tariff War:** The Trump administration's broad use of tariffs reshaped global trade flows. India, China, and the EU faced varying levels of trade friction.
- **Energy Markets:** UAE's exit from OPEC and continued geopolitical disruptions kept crude oil prices volatile, impacting import-dependent economies like India.
- **Green Finance:** The India-Nordic Green Partnership and multiple multilateral climate finance commitments marked significant steps in sustainable development funding.

4.3 Banking & Financial Sector

The Reserve Bank of India maintained a calibrated monetary policy stance. Key highlights include continued expansion of UPI-based payments internationally, RBI's pilot programmes for the Digital Rupee (e-Rupee), and regulatory focus on reducing NPAs in the banking system.

- **UPI Global Expansion:** India's UPI payment infrastructure expanded to several new countries, strengthening India's fintech diplomacy.
- **MSME Support:** Budget allocations and new credit guarantee schemes were introduced to support micro, small, and medium enterprises.
- **Stock Markets:** Indian equity markets showed resilience despite global volatility, with the BSE Sensex and NSE Nifty 50 reflecting investor confidence in India's growth story.

CHAPTER 5

Science & Technology

5.1 Artificial Intelligence

2026 has been a watershed year for AI adoption across sectors. India positioned itself as a key player through the AI Impact Summit 2026 and multiple national AI initiatives.

- **India AI Impact Summit 2026 (February):** India hosted global AI leaders, researchers, and policymakers to discuss responsible AI development, data governance, and AI's role in achieving SDGs.
- **IndiaAI Data Lab:** Chandigarh University partnered with Intel to launch India's first IndiaAI Data Lab at a private university, creating infrastructure for AI research and application development.
- **Samadhan Didi AI Chatbot:** India deployed an AI-powered citizen grievance chatbot, 'Samadhan Didi', to streamline public service delivery at the state level.
- **Global AI Race:** Major tech companies continued releasing advanced AI models, with competition intensifying between US, China, and European players in the large language model space.

5.2 Space Exploration

- **Artemis Programme:** NASA's Artemis mission to return astronauts to the Moon continues. A crewed lunar mission is expected in 2026, marking a significant step in deep-space exploration.
- **Commercial Air Taxis:** 2026 marked the commercial launch of electric air taxi services in several major global cities, ushering in a new era of urban air mobility.
- **Total Solar Eclipse (August 12, 2026):** A total solar eclipse will trace a path over Greenland, Iceland, and mainland Spain — Europe's first mainland totality since 1999.
- **Eta Aquariids Meteor Shower:** The meteor shower linked to Halley's Comet peaked in May 2026, with the best visibility in the Southern Hemisphere.

5.3 Key Technological Developments

Technology	Key Development in 2026
AI	India AI Impact Summit; ChatGPT and competing models in enterprise use
Space	Artemis crewed Moon mission preparations; commercial satellite boom
Air Mobility	Commercial eVTOL (electric air taxis) launch globally
Defence Tech	India demonstrates Harop loitering munitions; DRDO advances
Quantum	Global race for quantum supremacy intensifies; India's Quantum Mission active
5G/6G	India completes major 5G rollout; early 6G research ongoing

5.4 India's Defence Technology

Operation Sindoor demonstrated India's sophisticated defence technology capabilities to the world. The successful deployment of Israeli-origin Harop and Harpy loitering munitions, precision air strikes, and the coordinated tri-services operation showcased India's military-technological prowess. DRDO continues to develop indigenous systems including advanced missile platforms and drone warfare capabilities.

CHAPTER 6

Environment & Climate Change

6.1 India's Environmental Challenges

- **Kasauli Forest Fire:** A major forest fire in Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh prompted the Indian Air Force to deploy 'Bambi Bucket' aerial firefighting equipment — large water containers attached to helicopters — to douse the flames. This highlighted the need for enhanced wildfire management infrastructure.
- **Aravallis Degradation:** Environmental experts warned that the weakening of the Aravalli Range's forest cover is reducing its effectiveness as a shield protecting the Gangetic plains from dust storms and desertification originating from the Thar Desert.
- **Urban Heat:** Indian cities recorded record heat events in May-June 2026, with authorities issuing heat action plans across multiple states.

6.2 Climate Diplomacy

India reinforced its climate commitments on multiple international platforms. The India-Nordic Partnership emphasised green hydrogen and renewable energy cooperation. India's National Green Hydrogen Mission continues to position it as a future global hub for clean hydrogen production.

- **India-Nordic Green Partnership:** Partnership focuses on green hydrogen, offshore wind energy, and climate adaptation technologies.
- **Renewable Energy:** India's installed renewable energy capacity continued to grow, with solar and wind power additions meeting 2030 targets ahead of schedule in several metrics.
- **Ebola Outbreak — DRC:** The ongoing Ebola outbreak in eastern DRC underscored the link between environmental degradation, deforestation, and zoonotic disease emergence.

6.3 Global Climate Events

Event	Details
Solar Eclipse (Aug 12)	Total solar eclipse over Greenland, Iceland, and Spain
Meteor Shower	Eta Aquariids (Halley's Comet) — peak May 2026
Perseids Shower	Peak August 12-13, 2026 — excellent moonless conditions
Forest Fires	Kasauli (India), multiple European countries impacted
UAE-OPEC Exit	Energy transition signals in Gulf region

6.4 Aravalli Ecosystem

The Aravalli Range, one of the world's oldest fold mountain systems, runs across Rajasthan, Haryana, Delhi, and Gujarat. It serves as a critical ecological buffer against desert encroachment from the Thar

Desert. However, rampant mining, urban expansion, and deforestation have significantly weakened this natural shield. Experts warn that continued degradation could expose vast areas of northern India to desertification and severe dust storms.

CHAPTER 7

Sports & Awards

7.1 FIFA World Cup 2026

The most anticipated sporting event of the year, the FIFA World Cup 2026 kicks off on June 11, 2026. For the first time in history, the tournament is co-hosted by three nations — the United States, Mexico, and Canada. The expanded format features 48 teams (up from 32), with matches across 16 cities. The championship final is scheduled for July 19 at MetLife Stadium, New Jersey.

Tournament	FIFA World Cup 2026
Dates	June 11 – July 19, 2026
Host Nations	USA, Canada, Mexico (first-ever tri-nation hosting)
Teams	48 teams (expanded from 32)
Opening Match	Mexico City (Estadio Azteca)
Final Venue	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford, New Jersey, USA
No. of Cities	16 host cities across 3 nations

7.2 Women's T20 World Cup 2026

The ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 is being held in England and Wales from June 12 to July 5, 2026. Twelve cricket-playing nations are competing in what promises to be an exciting tournament hosted in iconic venues across England.

7.3 Wimbledon 2026

The prestigious Wimbledon Championships will take place from June 29 to July 12, 2026. Defending champions Jannik Sinner (Men's) and Iga Swiatek (Women's) are strong favourites to retain their titles on the grass courts of the All England Club.

7.4 Other Sports Events

- **Kentucky Derby 2026:** Golden Tempo won the Kentucky Derby, with trainer Cherie DeVaux becoming the first woman to train a Kentucky Derby winner.
- **2026 NBA Finals:** Ongoing at the time of publication — the NBA season continues to showcase top-level basketball competition.
- **2026 Stanley Cup Finals:** The NHL's pinnacle event is underway, with teams competing for ice hockey's greatest prize.
- **Formula One 2026:** The new technical regulations era with 100% sustainable fuels is reshaping the championship. New engine formats are creating fresh competition.

- **MLB All-Star Game:** Scheduled for July 14, 2026 in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.

7.5 Awards & Honours

- **Prof. M.S. Swaminathan Award 2026:** Recognising contributions to agriculture and food security — named after India's legendary agricultural scientist.
- **Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia:** Bhavitha Mandava, Chanel's Indian Ambassador, made the Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia 2026 list, gaining international recognition for Indian talent.

CHAPTER 8

Defence & Security

8.1 India's Military Capabilities Post-Sindoor

Operation Sindoor was a landmark demonstration of India's modern military capabilities. The tri-services operation — Army, Navy, and Air Force acting in coordinated fashion — was widely praised by military analysts globally. A Swiss military think-tank's report termed India's performance as establishing 'escalation dominance' over Pakistan.

- **Air Force:** IAF demonstrated deep-strike precision capability using Harop and Harpy loitering munitions; destroyed Pakistani air defence radars; claimed 5 PAF jets shot down.
- **Navy:** Unprecedented deployment of 30+ ships and submarines; carrier battle group under INS Vikrant positioned off Makran coast; forced Pakistan Navy to stay close to its coast.
- **Nuclear Thresholds:** India demonstrated restraint by not triggering nuclear escalation despite conducting strikes deep inside Pakistan, showcasing mature strategic decision-making.

8.2 Global Security Threats

- **Iran-US Conflict:** US military operations (Operation Epic Fury) against Iran's nuclear and military infrastructure created significant regional destabilisation. The initial phase is now concluded.
- **Russia-Ukraine:** Ongoing conflict with aerial bombardment of civilian infrastructure. Ukrainian drone strikes on Russian economic assets represent a new dimension of the conflict.
- **ADF Militants (DRC):** Allied Democratic Forces continue to target civilian populations in eastern DRC, underlining the persistent threat of non-state armed groups in Africa.
- **AQIS Threat:** Al-Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent (AQIS) used Operation Sindoor's context to call for jihad, though analysts assess it poses limited kinetic threat to India.

8.3 India's Defence Doctrine

Post-Operation Sindoor, India articulated a new counter-terror doctrine: any future cross-border terrorist attack will be met with a swift, decisive military response. This represents a significant shift from India's historically restrained approach. The doctrine is underpinned by the credible demonstration of India's military precision, tri-services coordination, and electronic warfare capabilities shown during Operation Sindoor.

CHAPTER 9

Governance, Polity & Social

9.1 India — Governance & Schemes

- **Samadhan Didi:** AI-powered chatbot launched for citizen grievance redressal, integrating technology with governance at state and district levels.
- **Navachar Mantra:** MSDE initiative to empower rural innovators and entrepreneurs through skill development, mentorship, and access to markets.
- **IndiaAI Data Lab (Chandigarh University):** First private university partnership with Intel to advance AI-based research and application development in India.
- **Indian Railways Reorganisation:** Creation of South Coast Railway Zone with a new 18-star logo representing India's expanding railway network.
- **IAF Bambi Bucket:** Indian Air Force's deployment of aerial firefighting technology (Bambi Buckets on helicopters) in Kasauli forest fire showcases civil-military cooperation in disaster management.

9.2 Women & Social Empowerment

2026 continued the trend of women breaking barriers in India and globally. Notable achievements include Wing Commander Vyomika Singh and Colonel Sofiya Qureshi leading Operation Sindoor briefings, Cherie DeVaux becoming the first woman trainer to win the Kentucky Derby, and Bhavitha Mandava making the Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia list.

9.3 International Governance

- **Peru Presidential Election:** Second round of Peru's presidential election held on June 7, 2026.
- **Kosovo Assembly Election:** Assembly elections in Kosovo on June 7, 2026.
- **Switzerland Referendums:** Swiss direct democracy in action with national referendums on June 14, 2026.
- **Ethiopia Parliament:** Ethiopian House of Peoples' Representatives election on June 1, 2026.
- **Obama Presidential Center:** Scheduled to open to the public in Chicago on June 19, 2026.

9.4 Important Reports & Indices 2026

Report	Key Finding / Relevance
WEF Global Competitiveness 2026	AI and green transition as key growth drivers
Economic Survey India 2025-26	India's robust growth projections; fiscal consolidation on track
CHPM Swiss Military Report	India's air superiority in Operation Sindoor; escalation dominance
Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia	Bhavitha Mandava (India) featured; growing Indian influence

Swiss Air Force Analysis

Harop munitions; precision strike capability of IAF analysed

CHAPTER 10

MCQ Practice Set — 50 Questions

Instructions: Each question has 4 options. The correct answer is marked with ✓.

Section A — Questions 1 to 25

Q1. On which date was Operation Sindoor launched by India?

- (A) April 22, 2025
- (B) May 7, 2025 ✓
- (C) May 10, 2025
- (D) June 1, 2025

Q2. How many terrorist sites were targeted in Operation Sindoor?

- (A) 5
- (B) 7
- (C) 9 ✓
- (D) 12

Q3. Operation Sindoor was named after:

- (A) A military base
- (B) The red powder worn by married women ✓
- (C) A river
- (D) A martyred soldier

Q4. Which Indian Navy vessel led the Carrier Battle Group during Operation Sindoor?

- (A) INS Vikramaditya
- (B) INS Vikrant ✓
- (C) INS Chennai
- (D) INS Arihant

Q5. The Pahalgam terror attack occurred on:

- (A) March 15, 2025
- (B) April 22, 2025 ✓
- (C) May 1, 2025
- (D) April 10, 2025

Q6. India's GDP growth in Jul-Sep 2025 quarter was:

- (A) 6.5%
- (B) 7.1%
- (C) 8.2% ✓
- (D) 9.0%

Q7. Which university launched India's first IndiaAI Data Lab?

- (A) IIT Delhi
- (B) Anna University
- (C) Chandigarh University ✓

(D) Manipal University

Q8. 'Samadhan Didi' is India's AI chatbot for:

- (A) Weather forecasting
- (B) Citizen grievance redressal ✓
- (C) Agricultural advice
- (D) Tax filing

Q9. 'Navachar Mantra' is an initiative of which ministry?

- (A) Ministry of Agriculture
- (B) Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship ✓
- (C) Ministry of Science & Technology
- (D) Ministry of Finance

Q10. Indian Railways created which new zone recently?

- (A) North Coast Railway Zone
- (B) South Coast Railway Zone ✓
- (C) East Frontier Railway Zone
- (D) Western Coastal Railway Zone

Q11. Which country withdrew from OPEC on May 1, 2026?

- (A) Saudi Arabia
- (B) Iraq
- (C) UAE ✓
- (D) Kuwait

Q12. The US House voted to limit war powers related to operations in:

- (A) Russia
- (B) North Korea
- (C) Iran ✓
- (D) Syria

Q13. The Obama Presidential Center is scheduled to open in:

- (A) Washington DC
- (B) New York
- (C) Chicago ✓
- (D) Los Angeles

Q14. Who won the Kentucky Derby 2026?

- (A) Golden Tempo ✓
- (B) Silver Storm
- (C) Desert Wind
- (D) Thunder Prince

Q15. Who trained the Kentucky Derby 2026 winner — making history as the first woman to do so?

- (A) Julie Krone
- (B) Cherie DeVaux ✓
- (C) Rosie Napravnik
- (D) Hayley Turner

Q16. FIFA World Cup 2026 is co-hosted by how many nations?

- (A) 1
- (B) 2
- (C) 3 ✓
- (D) 4

Q17. The FIFA World Cup 2026 final is scheduled at:

- (A) Wembley Stadium
- (B) MetLife Stadium, New Jersey ✓
- (C) Rose Bowl, California
- (D) Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

Q18. How many teams are playing in FIFA World Cup 2026?

- (A) 32
- (B) 36
- (C) 48 ✓
- (D) 64

Q19. Wimbledon 2026 defending champions are:

- (A) Djokovic and Swiatek
- (B) Sinner and Swiatek ✓
- (C) Alcaraz and Sabalenka
- (D) Sinner and Gauff

Q20. Women's T20 World Cup 2026 is hosted by:

- (A) India
- (B) Australia
- (C) England and Wales ✓
- (D) South Africa

Q21. Which mountain range acts as a natural shield for the Gangetic plains from desert winds?

- (A) Sahyadri
- (B) Aravalli ✓
- (C) Vindhya
- (D) Satpura

Q22. 'Bambi Bucket' is associated with:

- (A) Fishing operations
- (B) Aerial firefighting ✓
- (C) Crop dusting
- (D) Mine clearance

Q23. The 2026 total solar eclipse will be visible over mainland:

- (A) France
- (B) Germany
- (C) Spain ✓
- (D) Italy

Q24. The Ebola outbreak in 2026 occurred in which country?

- (A) Nigeria
- (B) Sierra Leone
- (C) DRC (Congo) ✓

(D) Ethiopia

Q25. Eta Aquariids meteor shower is linked to which comet?

(A) Comet NEOWISE

(B) Halley's Comet ✓

(C) Comet Hale-Bopp

(D) Comet Encke

CHAPTER 10 (Continued)

MCQ Practice Set — Questions 26–50

Section B — Questions 26 to 50

Q1. The Artemis programme is associated with:

- (A) Mars exploration
- (B) Moon crewed mission ✓
- (C) Space telescope
- (D) Asteroid mining

Q2. eVTOL stands for:

- (A) Electric Vertical Take-Off and Landing ✓
- (B) Enhanced Variable Transport On Land
- (C) Electric Vector Transport & Orbital Launch
- (D) Extended Vertical Technology On Lift

Q3. India's National Green Hydrogen Mission aims to make India a hub for:

- (A) Blue hydrogen
- (B) Grey hydrogen
- (C) Clean/green hydrogen ✓
- (D) Brown hydrogen

Q4. Which Israeli-origin munitions did India use in Operation Sindoor?

- (A) Spike missiles
- (B) Harop and Harpy loitering munitions ✓
- (C) Barak-8
- (D) Iron Dome

Q5. India's UPI digital payment system was expanded to:

- (A) Only 2 countries
- (B) Multiple new international markets ✓
- (C) SAARC nations only
- (D) EU only

Q6. The Third India-Nordic Summit (2026) was held in:

- (A) Helsinki
- (B) Copenhagen
- (C) Oslo ✓
- (D) Stockholm

Q7. India-Nordic ties were upgraded to a:

- (A) Defence Partnership
- (B) Green Technology & Innovation Strategic Partnership ✓
- (C) Maritime Security Alliance
- (D) Cultural Exchange Programme

Q8. The first India-Nordic Summit was held in which city?

- (A) Copenhagen
- (B) Oslo
- (C) Helsinki
- (D) Stockholm ✓

Q9. Swiss CHPM report on Operation Sindoor concluded India had:

- (A) Tactical failure
- (B) Air superiority that coerced Pakistan's ceasefire ✓
- (C) Navy superiority only
- (D) Nuclear deterrence failure

Q10. Which body is AQIS?

- (A) Al-Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent ✓
- (B) Asean-Qatar Investment Scheme
- (C) African-Qatar Intelligence System
- (D) Anti-Qatar Islamic Society

Q11. Kuwait expelled two diplomats of which country?

- (A) Iraq
- (B) Saudi Arabia
- (C) Iran ✓
- (D) Pakistan

Q12. Ukrainian drones struck which Russian city during the St. Petersburg Economic Forum?

- (A) Moscow
- (B) Murmansk
- (C) St. Petersburg (oil terminal) ✓
- (D) Vladivostok

Q13. The Somali Future Council is an:

- (A) Aid organisation
- (B) Opposition political group ✓
- (C) UN peacekeeping body
- (D) Regional trade group

Q14. Which project linked to the Trump family faced protests in Albania?

- (A) Oil pipeline
- (B) Luxury coastal development project ✓
- (C) Hotel chain
- (D) Military base

Q15. Peru held its presidential election (2nd round) on:

- (A) June 1, 2026
- (B) June 7, 2026 ✓
- (C) June 14, 2026
- (D) June 19, 2026

Q16. Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia 2026 featured which Indian personality?

- (A) Priya Kapoor
- (B) Ananya Birla

(C) Bhavitha Mandava ✓

(D) Neerja Sethi

Q17. Which IAF formation named 'Sindoor' was planned for Republic Day flypast?

(A) MiG-29 formation

(B) Rafale and Su-30 formation ✓

(C) Tejas jets only

(D) Apache helicopters

Q18. The MLB All-Star Game 2026 is in:

(A) New York

(B) Chicago

(C) Philadelphia ✓

(D) Los Angeles

Q19. India-US relations cooled because India:

(A) Signed a deal with China

(B) Refused to credit Trump for Operation Sindoor ceasefire ✓

(C) Left QUAD

(D) Joined CSTO

Q20. The ceasefire ending the 2025 India-Pakistan conflict came on:

(A) May 7, 2025

(B) May 9, 2025

(C) May 10, 2025 ✓

(D) May 12, 2025

Q21. BRICS Summit 2026 is hosted by:

(A) Brazil

(B) Russia

(C) India ✓

(D) South Africa

Q22. The 2026 Formula One season is notable for:

(A) New aerodynamic rules only

(B) 100% sustainable fuel mandate and new engine formats ✓

(C) Increase to 25 races

(D) New tyre compounds only

Q23. India's GDP makes it the _____ largest economy in the world:

(A) 3rd

(B) 4th

(C) 5th ✓

(D) 6th

Q24. Operation Epic Fury was the codename for US military operations against:

(A) Russia

(B) North Korea

(C) Iran ✓

(D) Syria

Q25. The Perseids meteor shower peaks in:

- (A) June 2026
- (B) July 2026
- (C) August 2026 ✓
- (D) September 2026

Q26. Which Indian news agency covered the hospital fire in Muzaffarpur, Bihar?

- (A) ANI
- (B) PTI
- (C) NDTV ✓
- (D) Reuters

CHAPTER 11

India & World — Bilateral & Multilateral Relations

11.1 India-US Relations

The India-US relationship entered a complex phase in 2025-26. The strong personal rapport between Prime Minister Modi and President Trump built through 2024 faced strain following Operation Sindoor and India's refusal to publicly credit Trump for brokering the ceasefire. Washington responded with punitive tariffs, while geopolitical cooperation on Indo-Pacific security remains an underlying shared interest.

Tariff Rate	50% on Indian goods linked to Russian crude purchases
QUAD Status	Quad summit postponed; potential revival pending trade deal
Trade Deal	Under negotiation; disagreements persist on market access
Tech Cooperation	Continues despite political friction — semiconductors, AI, space
Defence	US-India defence partnership remains strong at institutional level

11.2 India-China Relations

India-China ties show cautious improvement following the 2020 Galwan clash and gradual disengagement from border standoffs. Chinese President Xi Jinping may visit India for the BRICS Summit 2026, which would be a significant diplomatic milestone. However, fundamental trust deficits and border disputes remain unresolved.

- **BRICS 2026:** India as host chair; Xi Jinping's potential visit would signal normalisation of high-level diplomatic engagement.
- **Trade Deficit:** India continues to run a large trade deficit with China, prompting calls for domestic manufacturing under 'Make in India' and PLI schemes.
- **Border:** LAC (Line of Actual Control) patrol agreements from late 2024 continue to hold, with both sides maintaining de-escalation posture.

11.3 India-Russia Relations

India maintained its strategic autonomy by continuing to purchase discounted Russian crude oil, despite US pressure. Russian President Putin visited India in December 2025, underscoring the resilience of the India-Russia 'Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership'. India abstained from UN votes on Russia-Ukraine, maintaining its non-aligned posture.

11.4 India-EU Relations

European Commission President Ursula Von der Leyen and European Council President António Costa were chief guests at India's Republic Day 2026, signalling the deepening of India-EU ties. The India-EU

Free Trade Agreement (FTA) negotiations continue with renewed momentum.

11.5 India's Multilateral Engagements

BRICS 2026	India as host; expanded BRICS+ format with new members
India-Nordic Summit	3rd edition, Oslo — Green Tech & Innovation Partnership
QUAD	Postponed; India-US tensions as reason
G20	India's legacy presidency from 2023 continues to influence global agenda
SCO	India active in Shanghai Cooperation Organisation forums
UN Security Council	India pursuing permanent UNSC membership

CHAPTER 12

Important Schemes, Reports & Institutions

12.1 Key Government Schemes 2025-26

Samadhan Didi	AI chatbot for citizen grievance redressal
Navachar Mantra	MSDE initiative for rural innovators and entrepreneurs
IndiaAI Data Lab	Chandigarh Univ-Intel partnership for AI research
National Green Hydrogen Mission	India as global green hydrogen production hub by 2030
PLI Schemes	Production-Linked Incentives across 14 sectors to boost manufacturing
PM Gati Shakti	National Master Plan for multi-modal connectivity infrastructure
Digital India Mission	Expanding digital infrastructure and digital public goods
Jal Jeevan Mission	Har Ghar Jal — tap water to every rural household
PM Vishwakarma	Support scheme for traditional artisans and craftspeople
FAME India (Phase III)	Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of EVs

12.2 Important International Reports 2026

WEF Global Competitiveness 2026	AI and green transition as top growth themes
India Economic Survey 2025-26	8%+ growth projected; green growth emphasis
CHPM Swiss Military Report	India's air superiority in Operation Sindoor
IMF World Economic Outlook	India fastest-growing major economy in 2025-26
UNDP Human Development Report	India's HDI improvement; gender gaps persist
Global Hunger Index 2025	India's food security challenges highlighted
Freedom House Report 2026	Democracy under pressure globally
Transparency International CPI	Corruption perceptions across nations

12.3 International Organisations — Key Updates

- **OPEC:** UAE's exit weakened OPEC's cohesion. Saudi Arabia now faces greater pressure to manage oil output unilaterally.
- **UN:** UNSC reform discussions continue with India, Brazil, Germany, and Japan pushing for permanent membership.

- **WHO:** WHO coordinates Ebola response in DRC; global health governance reforms post-COVID continue.
- **FIFA:** World Cup 2026 is FIFA's biggest event — first 48-team tournament generates record revenues.
- **ICC:** Women's T20 World Cup 2026 in England demonstrates ICC's commitment to growing women's cricket.
- **IAEA:** Closely monitoring Iran's nuclear activities post-US military operations.

CHAPTER 13

Exam-Ready Summary — One-Liners

13.1 One-Liner Facts (National)

- Operation Sindoor was launched on May 7, 2025 targeting 9 terror sites in Pakistan and PoK.
- The Pahalgam terror attack on April 22, 2025 killed 26 tourists in Kashmir.
- India's GDP grew at 8.2% (Jul-Sep 2025) — fastest among major economies.
- Chandigarh University launched India's first IndiaAI Data Lab with Intel.
- Samadhan Didi is India's AI chatbot for citizen grievance redressal.
- MSDE launched 'Navachar Mantra' for rural entrepreneurs.
- Indian Railways formed a new South Coast Railway Zone with an 18-star logo.
- India-Nordic ties upgraded to Green Technology & Innovation Strategic Partnership at Oslo Summit.
- India hosts BRICS Summit 2026; Xi Jinping's visit possible.
- Ursula Von der Leyen was chief guest at India's Republic Day 2026.
- India's National Green Hydrogen Mission aims to produce 5 million tonnes by 2030.
- IAF deployed Bambi Buckets (aerial firefighting equipment) in Kasauli forest fire.
- Aravalli Range's degradation threatens to expose Gangetic plains to desertification.
- Trump imposed 50% tariffs on India over Russian crude oil purchases.
- India's Quad summit postponed due to India-US tensions post-Operation Sindoor.

13.2 One-Liner Facts (International)

- UAE withdrew from OPEC on May 1, 2026 — a historic break from the oil cartel.
- FIFA World Cup 2026: USA, Canada, Mexico co-host; 48 teams; final at MetLife Stadium.
- US military Operation Epic Fury targeted Iran; initial phase concluded.
- US House voted 215-208 to limit war powers and halt Iran military operations.
- Russia killed 22 civilians in aerial attacks on Kyiv on June 2, 2026.
- Ukraine struck an oil terminal in St. Petersburg with drones.
- Kuwait expelled two Iranian diplomats in June 2026.
- ADF militants killed 16 civilians in DRC's Beni Territory, North Kivu.
- Ebola outbreak in Mongbwalu, DRC (2026) required emergency WHO response.
- Pakistan hosted US-Iran talks in Islamabad on April 11-12, 2026.
- Golden Tempa won Kentucky Derby 2026; trained by Cherie DeVaux — first woman trainer to win.
- Wimbledon 2026: Defending champs are Jannik Sinner (M) and Iga Swiatek (W).
- Women's T20 World Cup 2026 held in England and Wales (Jun 12 – Jul 5).
- Total Solar Eclipse August 12, 2026 — first mainland Europe totality since 1999 (Spain).

- US celebrates 250th Independence Day (Semiquincentennial) on July 4, 2026.
- Obama Presidential Center opens in Chicago on June 19, 2026.
- Israel's ultra-Orthodox protests against mandatory military service — June 2026.
- Bhavitha Mandava (Chanel Ambassador) — Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia 2026.
- MLB All-Star Game 2026 in Philadelphia on July 14.
- Formula One 2026: 100% sustainable fuels mandate and new engine format.

CHAPTER 14

Key Terms & Terminologies

Operation Sindoor	India's May 2025 military operation targeting terror infrastructure in Pakistan and PoK after the Pahalgam attack
Loitering Munition	A type of autonomous weapon that 'loiters' in the air before striking a target; Harop and Harpy are Israeli-origin examples used by India
Bambi Bucket	A large, collapsible bucket attached to a helicopter used to scoop up and drop water on wildfires
eVTOL	Electric Vertical Take-Off and Landing — the technology behind commercial air taxis
Semiquincentennial	The 250th anniversary; used to describe the US's 250th Independence Day in 2026
Escalation Dominance	A military concept where one side has the ability to escalate a conflict to any level and prevail; attributed to India in Op. Sindoor
BRICS+	The expanded BRICS group including new members like UAE, Saudi Arabia, Ethiopia, Iran, Egypt, and Argentina
Green Hydrogen	Hydrogen produced by electrolysis of water using renewable energy — considered key to decarbonising heavy industry
Persona Non Grata	A diplomatic term declaring a foreign official unwelcome in a country, effectively expelling them
PLI Scheme	Production-Linked Incentive — India's scheme offering financial incentives for increased manufacturing output in specified sectors
QUAD	Quadrilateral Security Dialogue — a strategic grouping of USA, India, Japan, and Australia focused on Indo-Pacific security
SCO	Shanghai Cooperation Organisation — Eurasian political, economic, and security organisation; India is a full member
LAC	Line of Actual Control — the de facto border between India and China
ADF	Allied Democratic Forces — a militant group operating in eastern DRC; linked to global jihadist networks
AQIS	Al-Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent — a regional affiliate of Al-Qaeda operating in South Asia
OPEC	Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries — coordinates petroleum policies among member nations
CHPM	Centre d'Histoire et de Prospective Militaires — Swiss military think-tank that published the Operation Sindoor analysis

Harop	An Israeli anti-radiation/loitering munition capable of autonomous target acquisition; used by IAF in Op. Sindoor
IndiaAI	India's national AI mission under the Ministry of Electronics and IT; aims to build AI compute, datasets, and applications
Navachar Mantra	MSDE initiative meaning 'Mantra of Innovation'; empowers rural entrepreneurs through structured skill development

CHAPTER 15

Fill in the Blanks & Match the Following

15.1 Fill in the Blanks

1. Operation Sindoor targeted _____ terrorist sites. **Ans: 9**
2. The Pahalgam attack occurred on _____ 2025. **Ans: April 22**
3. India's GDP growth (Jul-Sep 2025) was _____. **Ans: 8.2%**
4. FIFA World Cup 2026 final venue is _____. **Ans: MetLife Stadium, New Jersey**
5. UAE exited OPEC on _____. **Ans: May 1, 2026**
6. Cherie DeVaux trained _____ to win Kentucky Derby 2026. **Ans: Golden Tempo**
7. India-Nordic Summit (3rd edition, 2026) was held in _____. **Ans: Oslo, Norway**
8. 'Samadhan Didi' is an AI chatbot for _____. **Ans: citizen grievance redressal**
9. The ceasefire between India and Pakistan came on _____. **Ans: May 10, 2025**
10. The 2026 total solar eclipse will be visible over mainland _____. **Ans: Spain**
11. INS _____ led the carrier battle group during Operation Sindoor. **Ans: Vikrant**
12. The expanded FIFA World Cup 2026 features _____ teams. **Ans: 48**
13. Wimbledon 2026 defending Women's champion is _____. **Ans: Iga Swiatek**
14. Bhavitha Mandava is the Indian ambassador for _____. **Ans: Chanel**
15. India is hosting _____ Summit in 2026. **Ans: BRICS**

15.2 Match the Following — Events & Dates

Column A — Event	Column B — Date	Answer
A. Operation Sindoor launch	1. June 29	A–B
B. Pahalgam attack	2. May 7, 2025	A–D

C. UAE exits OPEC	3. June 12	A–F
D. FIFA WC 2026 start	4. April 22, 2025	A–G
E. Wimbledon 2026 start	5. August 12	A–A
F. Women's T20 WC 2026 start	6. May 1, 2026	A–C
G. Solar Eclipse 2026	7. June 11	A–E
H. US 250th Anniversary	8. July 4	A–H

CHAPTER 16

Detailed Notes — Special Topics

16.1 India's Counter-Terror Doctrine — A Historical Perspective

Historically, India has practised 'strategic restraint' in response to cross-border terrorism — absorbing provocations while maintaining diplomatic pressure on Pakistan. This approach was informed by the nuclear overhang, fear of escalation, and pressure from global powers to maintain stability in South Asia.

The 2016 Uri attack triggered India's first publicly acknowledged 'Surgical Strike' across the LoC — a limited operation targeting terror launch pads. The 2019 Pulwama attack led to the Balakot air strikes — India's first cross-border air strikes since 1971. Operation Sindoor in 2025 represents a decisive shift: India struck 9 targets deep inside Pakistan proper (not just PoK) and sustained a 4-day air conflict, establishing a new normal in India's counter-terror response architecture.

Key evolution of India's doctrine:

Pre-2016	Strategic restraint — no direct military response to cross-border terrorism
2016 (Uri)	Surgical Strikes across LoC — targeted terror camps
2019 (Pulwama)	Balakot air strikes — first cross-border air strikes since 1971
2025 (Pahalgam)	Operation Sindoor — 9 sites deep in Pakistan; 4-day air war
Post-2025	New doctrine: firm, decisive response to any future terror attack

16.2 The FIFA World Cup 2026 — All You Need to Know

The 2026 FIFA World Cup is the most expansive in the tournament's history. For the first time, three nations co-host: the United States (11 venues), Canada (2 venues), and Mexico (3 venues). The expanded 48-team format introduced in 2026 creates more matches, more revenue, and more opportunities for smaller footballing nations.

- **Opening Match:** The tournament opens at Estadio Azteca, Mexico City — home to some of football's most legendary moments.
- **Final:** MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford, New Jersey — capacity of ~82,000.
- **Group Stage:** 48 teams divided into 12 groups of 4; top 2 and 8 best 3rd-place teams advance.
- **Timeline:** June 11 – July 19, 2026 — 6 weeks of football across North America.
- **Economic Impact:** Estimated to generate tens of billions in economic activity across the three host nations.

16.3 India's Green Energy Transition

India has set ambitious renewable energy targets: 500 GW of non-fossil fuel capacity by 2030. Solar and wind are the primary drivers, with India's solar installations growing exponentially. The National Green

Hydrogen Mission (launched 2023) targets production of 5 million metric tonnes of green hydrogen per year by 2030 at a cost of less than \$1 per kg. India-Nordic partnerships provide complementary technology and financing.

- **Solar:** India has among the world's largest solar installation programmes; costs have fallen below Rs 2 per unit.
- **Wind:** Offshore wind targets set; coastal states developing capacity.
- **Green Hydrogen:** NTPC, ONGC, and Reliance are key players in green H2 production.
- **EV Transition:** FAME India Phase III supports EV adoption; domestic EV manufacturing is growing.

FINAL SUMMARY

Comprehensive Recap — June 2026

This digest covered the following major themes:

National Affairs	India's political landscape, state elections, governance schemes (Samadhan Didi, Navachar Mantra), IndiaAI, Railways
Operation Sindoor	India's May 2025 military operation: 9 terror sites, tri-services, air superiority, new counter-terror doctrine
International Relations	US-Iran conflict, Russia-Ukraine war, Israel-Lebanon, Kuwait-Iran, UAE-OPEC exit, Pakistan diplomacy
Economy	India GDP 8.2%, US tariffs, UAE OPEC exit, WEF 2026, India-Nordic green partnership, digital economy
Science & Tech	AI Impact Summit, IndiaAI Lab, Artemis Moon mission, eVTOL air taxis, loitering munitions
Environment	Kasauli fire, Aravalli degradation, Total Solar Eclipse Aug 2026, Ebola DRC, green hydrogen
Sports	FIFA WC 2026 (48 teams, 3 nations), Women's T20 WC, Wimbledon, Kentucky Derby, NBA Finals
Defence	Operation Sindoor — air, naval, missile capabilities; DRDO; India's new military doctrine
Governance	Schemes, women achievers, international elections, Obama Centre, BRICS hosting
MCQs	50 practice questions covering all major topics for competitive exam preparation

Best of luck in your examinations!

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Current Affairs Digest — June 2026 | Compiled June 5, 2026

Sources: Britannica, Wikipedia, NPR, The Diplomat, PMF IAS, Adda247, CHPM Swiss Report, Chatham House

Key Numbers & Dates to Remember

Operation Sindoor date	May 7, 2025
Pahalgam attack date	April 22, 2025
Ceasefire date	May 10, 2025
Terror sites targeted	9 (in Pakistan & PoK)
FIFA World Cup start	June 11, 2026
FIFA World Cup final	July 19, 2026 — MetLife Stadium, NJ
India GDP growth (Jul-Sep 2025)	8.2%
US tariff on India	50% on select goods
Women's T20 WC 2026	June 12 – July 5, England & Wales
Wimbledon 2026	June 29 – July 12
Solar Eclipse 2026	August 12, 2026 — Spain/Iceland/Greenland
US 250th Anniversary	July 4, 2026
Obama Center Opening	June 19, 2026 — Chicago
UAE exits OPEC	May 1, 2026
Kuwait expels Iran diplomats	June 2026
Kentucky Derby winner	Golden Tempo (trainer: Cherie DeVaux)
India-Nordic Summit	3rd Summit — Oslo 2026